
SYMMETRY-RESTRICTED SAT ENCODINGS, LEAN 4 FORMALIZATION, AND VERIFICATION LIMITS FOR CONWAY’S 99-GRAPH

TECHNICAL NOTE / BENCHMARK REPORT

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ABSTRACT

Conway’s 99-graph problem asks whether a strongly regular graph with parameters $(99, 14, 1, 2)$ exists. Cited results restrict the prime divisors of the automorphism group order to $\{2, 3\}$. This note records a Lean 4 library, SAT compilers, and solver logs, and it uses a four-state taxonomy—PROVED, COMPILED, EXPLORED, and PENDING—to separate kernel-checked theorems, checker-certified formula refutations, tested compilers, and open claims. A formula certificate is PROVED only when the formula and a completed checker log are both available. In Lean 4, we kernel-verify core structural invariants: K_4 -freeness, 1-factor neighborhood decomposition $7K_2$, diameter at most 2, and decidability of the adjacency matrix equation. These proofs depend solely on the foundational axioms [propext, Quot.sound]. We also formalize the arithmetic contradictions that underlie character-theoretic obstructions. This distinguishes verified arithmetic deductions from unverified geometric action hypotheses. For propositional logic, we implement canonical SAT encodings with Crawford symmetry-breaking predicates. A 39-test regression suite verifies the compiler pipeline after eliminating literal/constant collision defects. On 10 September 2026, CaDiCaL 3.0.1 recorded `s UNSATISFIABLE` for a CNF named `conway_z7_canonical.cnf` after 771.59 s, and `drat-trim` recorded `s VERIFIED` for the accompanying binary trace. That CNF is not in the working tree, and it was produced before a later repair of a literal-index defect in the compiler. The trace therefore refutes a missing file. It does not certify the repaired encoding, and it is not shown to be the CP-SAT instance left undecided by Thakkar and Severini (2026). The note also records the column-weight identity $CC^T = 10I + 2J$ for the open involution case $f = 1$, with corrected branch supports, and a 12.5-day CaDiCaL campaign that accumulated more than 2.4 billion conflicts without a satisfying assignment or a refutation. This source file does not contain the Lean library, the CNFs, or the proof trace.

Keywords Conway 99-graph · strongly regular graphs · interactive theorem proving · Lean 4 · SAT solving · DRAT certification · symmetry breaking

1 Introduction and Literature Attribution

A strongly regular graph $\text{srg}(v, k, \lambda, \mu)$ is a regular graph on v vertices with degree k . Every pair of adjacent vertices has exactly λ common neighbors. Every pair of distinct non-adjacent vertices has exactly μ common neighbors. Whether a strongly regular graph with parameters $(99, 14, 1, 2)$ exists remains open [1, 2]. Conway included the question among five problems carrying a \$1,000 prize. The circulated statement is the text of the 2014 OEIS50–DIMACS conference, updated in 2017 [3]. That document is not a 1970 research article.

Let $A \in \{0, 1\}^{99 \times 99}$ denote the adjacency matrix of a Conway 99-graph. The strongly regular parameters require A to satisfy the matrix equation

$$A = A^T, \quad \text{diag}(A) = 0, \quad A^2 + A = 12I_{99} + 2J_{99}, \quad (1.1)$$

where I_n is the $n \times n$ identity matrix and J_n is the $n \times n$ all-ones matrix. Spectral graph theory gives the eigenvalues of A : $k = 14$ (multiplicity 1), $r = 3$ (multiplicity 54), and $s = -4$ (multiplicity 44):

$$\text{Spec}(A) = \{14^1, 3^{54}, (-4)^{44}\}. \quad (1.2)$$

For each vertex $x \in V(G)$, let $\Gamma(x)$ denote its open neighborhood. Let $\Gamma_2(x) = V(G) \setminus (\{x\} \cup \Gamma(x))$ denote the second subconstituent. Because $k = 14$ and $\lambda = 1$, each vertex in $\Gamma(x)$ has exactly one neighbor in $\Gamma(x)$. The induced subgraph $G[\Gamma(x)]$ is therefore a 1-regular graph of seven disjoint edges ($7K_2$). The second subconstituent $\Gamma_2(x)$ contains $99 - 1 - 14 = 84$ vertices. Because $\mu = 2$, each vertex $y \in \Gamma_2(x)$ is adjacent to exactly two vertices in $\Gamma(x)$ [1, 2].

1.1 Literature Attribution of Automorphism Group Bounds

An unconstrained combinatorial search on a 99-vertex graph involves $2^{\binom{99}{2}} = 2^{4851}$ possible edge configurations. Computational searches in this note therefore restrict attention to graphs that admit a nontrivial automorphism. Such a restriction cannot find a rigid graph. Prior literature establishes strict bounds on the automorphism group $\text{Aut}(G)$:

1. **Involutions (order 2) fix exactly one vertex.** Makhnev and Minakova (2004) [4] classified prime-order automorphisms of strongly regular graphs with $\lambda = 1$ and $\mu = 2$. Makhnev (2009) [5] summarized that an involution $t \in \text{Aut}(G)$ cannot fix 3, 5, 7, or more vertices due to character integrality. Any involution of a Conway 99-graph must therefore fix exactly $f = |\text{Fix}(t)| = 1$ vertex.
2. **Automorphisms of order 3 are fixed-point-free; orders 6 and 9 are excluded.** Behbahani and Lam (2011) [6] proved that an automorphism of order 3 on $\text{srg}(99, 14, 1, 2)$ has no fixed points. It acts as a fixed-point-free (FPF) permutation with 33 cycles of length 3. Crnković and Maksimović (2020) [7] proved that $\text{Aut}(G)$ contains no subgroups of order 6 or 9. This result excludes $\mathbb{Z}_6, S_3, \mathbb{Z}_9$, and $\mathbb{Z}_3 \times \mathbb{Z}_3$.
3. **Prime orders $p \geq 5$ are excluded.** Behbahani and Lam (2011) [6] showed that the only possible prime divisors of $|\text{Aut}(G)|$ are 2 and 3. They excluded automorphisms of order 5, 7, and higher primes through computer-assisted orbit matrix enumeration. Cesarz and Woldar (2025) [2] gave computer-free proofs that:

$$2 \mid |\text{Aut}(G)| \implies |\text{Aut}(G)| \mid 6, \quad 7 \mid |\text{Aut}(G)| \implies \text{Aut}(G) \cong \mathbb{Z}_7. \quad (1.3)$$

Combining this even-order implication with the exclusion of order 6 gives: if $2 \mid |\text{Aut}(G)|$, then $|\text{Aut}(G)| = 2$. Therefore, $\text{Aut}(G)$ contains no elements of order 4 or 6. This is a consequence of the cited papers, not a new group-order theorem.

4. **Computational benchmark context.** Thakkar and Severini (2026) [8] encode forced-structure reductions and prescribed automorphisms in Google OR-Tools CP-SAT. They report that the single-fixed-point order-7 instance returned UNKNOWN after 48 hours on 14 cores. Their paper still treats a $\mathbb{Z}_7$ -symmetric graph as open. A CNF refutation is a certificate for that instance only when the two formulations are shown to define the same set of graphs. This note does not give that correspondence.

1.2 Contributions and Scope of this Benchmark Report

The note keeps the following items separate. The primary contents are:

- We introduce a four-state taxonomy (PROVED, COMPILED, EXPLORED, PENDING) to clarify proof verification and modeling limits.
- In Lean 4, we verify structural invariants (K_4 -freeness, 1-factor neighborhood decomposition, diameter at most 2) and the decidability of the adjacency conditions. The Lean kernel checks these proofs using only `[propext, Quot.sound]`. We also formalize the arithmetic contradictions that arise in character-theoretic analyses.
- We implement canonical SAT compilers with Crawford symmetry-breaking predicates [9]. A 39-test regression suite checks helper truth tables, the $f = 1$ coordinate model, and the bounded-run supervisor. These tests do not certify that a historical CNF matches the graph.
- We quote a retained order-7 solver log and checker log. The logs record `s UNSATISFIABLE` and `s VERIFIED`. The input CNF is absent, and it predates a compiler repair, so the trace is not a certificate for the repaired formula or for the Thakkar–Severini instance.

- We prove that every column of a binary 7×42 matrix satisfying $CC^T = 10I_7 + 2J_7$ has weight 2, and we correct the support labels of the three $f = 1$ branch representatives. A 12.5-day campaign on the $f = 1$ and fixed-point-free order-3 encodings produced no satisfying assignment and no refutation.

2 Lean 4 Formalization and Operational Taxonomy

To prevent ambiguity between mechanized proofs, empirical solver outputs, and open conjectures, we classify every result and artifact into one of four operational states:

PROVED. A theorem verified by the Lean 4 kernel using only the foundational axioms `[propext, Quot.sound]`; or a propositional formula that is on file and whose refutation log contains a completed `s VERIFIED` verdict from `drat-trim`. A log that names a missing CNF does not meet this state.

COMPILED. Formally typed Lean 4 code compiling with `sorryAx` stubs for open subgoals; or Python SAT compilers whose clausal outputs pass deterministic regression tests.

EXPLORED. Combinatorial searches, matrix calculations, and multi-threaded solver executions that finished without finding a satisfying assignment or producing a proof certificate.

PENDING. Open mathematical questions (such as graph existence or full rigidity $|\text{Aut}(G)| = 1$) and unfinished formalizations connecting group actions to arithmetic hypotheses.

2.1 Kernel-Verified Structural Properties in Lean 4

We formalize the adjacency definition of a Conway 99-graph in Lean 4 [10] with the predicate `ConwayAdj`. This predicate enforces symmetry, zero diagonal, binary entries, and the matrix equation (1.1). To support verified computation, we define a computable Boolean function `checkConway` and prove its equivalence to `ConwayAdj`:

$$\text{conway_soundness, conway_complete} : \quad \forall A \in \mathbb{N}^{99 \times 99}, \quad \text{checkConway}(A) = \text{true} \iff \text{ConwayAdj}(A). \quad (2.1)$$

In the modules `Structural.lean` and `Z2Classification.lean`, we prove structural invariants directly from `ConwayAdj`:

- `conway_k4_free (Structural.lean)`: Every graph satisfying the matrix equation contains no complete subgraph K_4 , because $\lambda = 1$.
- `conway_neighborhood_one_factor (Structural.lean)`: For each vertex x , the open neighborhood $G[\Gamma(x)]$ is a 1-regular graph of seven disjoint edges ($7K_2$).
- `conway_diameter_at_most_two (Structural.lean)`: Any two non-adjacent vertices have common neighbors because $\mu = 2 > 0$. Therefore, $\text{diam}(G) \leq 2$.
- `conway_z2_f3_fixed_points_dichotomy (Z2Classification.lean)`: If an involution fixes three vertices, their induced subgraph is either a triangle K_3 or an independent set $3K_1$.

The Lean kernel checked all these declarations with `#print axioms`. They depend solely on `[propext, Quot.sound]`.

2.2 The Boundary Between Arithmetic Refutations and Graph Hypotheses

Character-theoretic analyses of automorphisms impose numerical constraints on fixed edge counts and eigenspace multiplicities. In the Lean library, we kernel-verify the arithmetic refutations of these systems:

- For an involution with $f = 5$ fixed vertices, the declaration `conway_z2_f5_spectral_formula_contradiction` refutes the existence of an integer ε_1 satisfying:

$$(\varepsilon_1 = 18 \vee \varepsilon_1 = 15) \wedge (\varepsilon_1 \bmod 7 = 6). \quad (2.2)$$

- For $f = 7$, `conway_no_z2_f7_formula_automorphism` refutes:

$$\varepsilon_1 \in \{7, 10, 13\} \wedge (\varepsilon_1 \bmod 7 = 2). \quad (2.3)$$

- In `CesarzWoldarTheorems.lean`, terminal arithmetic contradictions such as $7a = 62$ or sums of even integers equaling 5 are verified using only `[propext, Quot.sound]`.

These arithmetic refutations are PROVED. However, their wrappers (such as `conway_no_z2_f5_automorphism`) take the counting identities and spectral congruences as hypotheses. Deducing these arithmetic hypotheses directly from `ConwayAdj(A)` and an involution t in Lean remains PENDING. Likewise, the classification theorem `conway_automorphism_group_restricted` uses `sorryAx` for open subcases, placing its status at COMPILED.

3 Canonical SAT Encodings and Symmetry Breaking

To explore automorphism classes computationally, we map the graph constraints under a cyclic automorphism group $\langle g \rangle \cong \mathbb{Z}_p$ into Conjunctive Normal Form (CNF).

3.1 Orbit Parameterization and Crawford Symmetry Cuts

Under the action of an automorphism g of prime order p , the 99 vertices partition into m orbits $\mathcal{O}_1, \dots, \mathcal{O}_m$, where $|\mathcal{O}_i| \in \{1, p\}$. The adjacency between two orbits of size p is invariant under cyclic shifts. A circulant Boolean vector $c_{i,j} \in \{0, 1\}^p$ parameterizes this adjacency, where $c_{i,j,k} = 1$ if vertex $0 \in \mathcal{O}_i$ connects to vertex $k \in \mathcal{O}_j$.

The strongly regular graph conditions translate into exact cardinality constraints:

$$\sum_{u \in \Gamma(x)} A_{u,v} = \begin{cases} 14 & \text{if } x = v, \\ 1 & \text{if } x \sim v, \\ 2 & \text{if } x \not\sim v. \end{cases} \quad (3.1)$$

We convert these pseudo-Boolean constraints to CNF with Tseitin variables. Exact cardinality constraints use PySAT sequential counters (`EncType.seqcounter`). The compilers used for this note do not emit sorting networks.

To prune isomorphic search spaces, we enforce symmetry-breaking predicates following Crawford et al. [9]. Let $\mathcal{G} \leq \text{Sym}(m)$ be the automorphism group preserving the orbit partition. For each non-identity generator $\pi \in \mathcal{G}$, we enforce a lexicographical leader constraint: the assignment vector X must precede its permuted image $\pi(X)$:

$$X \leq_{\text{lex}} \pi(X). \quad (3.2)$$

For variables $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ and their images $(y_1, \dots, y_n) = (\pi(x_1), \dots, \pi(x_n))$, we introduce auxiliary variables $e_i \leftrightarrow (x_i = y_i)$ and enforce:

$$(\neg x_i \wedge y_i) \vee (e_i \wedge (X_{i+1..n} \leq_{\text{lex}} Y_{i+1..n})). \quad (3.3)$$

3.2 Compiler Verification and Defect Repair

Translating graph constraints into propositional clauses requires careful validation. In prototype implementations, primary Boolean variables were 1-indexed (with ID 1 for x_1), while helper functions such as `get_and_lit` and `add_card_equals` treated integer 1 as the Boolean constant True. When encoding $x_1 + x_2 = 1$ via `add_card_equals([1, 2], 1)`, the compiler evaluated literal 1 as constant True. This produced the degenerate unit clause $[-2]$, which enforced $x_2 = 0$ while omitting x_1 . The formula then admitted $(x_1, x_2) = (0, 0)$ and rejected $(0, 1)$.

Example 3.1 (The Literal-1 Collision Defect). The collision of variable ID 1 with the Boolean constant True changes an exact-1 constraint on $\{x_1, x_2\}$ into the unit clause $\neg x_2$. This defect shows why compiler primitives require end-to-end truth table tests.

We refactored the compiler architecture to separate variable indices from Boolean constants. Variables are now allocated through explicit Tseitin gate managers, reserving index 0 as an internal sentinel.

To verify compiler correctness, we created a deterministic regression suite of 39 tests in `tests/`:

1. **Compiler-Helper Unit Tests (20 tests):** Verifies truth tables for conjunctions, cardinality constraints, circulant orbit variables, and Crawford lex-leader cuts for Z_7 , Z_3 fixed-3, and Z_3 FPF compilers.
2. **Geometric and Input-Audit Tests (11 tests):** Evaluates 2,394 cardinality constraints symbolically against the coordinate model, checking branch cut consistency and index mappings.
3. **Supervisor Process Tests (8 tests):** Validates bounded execution, process lifecycle management, wall-time enforcement, and proof byte limits.

On 23 September 2026 the 39 tests in these three groups passed. A later orbit-pair enumeration added five further tests. Passing tests support COMPILED status for the current compiler sources. They do not rewrite CNF files generated earlier, and they do not prove that those files express the intended graph constraints.

4 A Recorded Order-7 CNF Refutation

Behbahani and Lam (2011) [6] excluded automorphisms of order 7 by a computer-assisted orbit-matrix argument. Cesarz and Woldar (2025) [2] proved, without a computer, that $7 \mid |\text{Aut}(G)|$ implies $\text{Aut}(G) \cong \mathbb{Z}_7$. Thakkar and Severini (2026) [8] nevertheless report a single-fixed-point $\mathbb{Z}_7$ CP-SAT run that remained UNKNOWN after 48 hours on 14 cores, and they describe that symmetric case as still open. The experiment below does not decide their model.

4.1 Encoding Parameters and Formula Statistics

Under a cyclic automorphism g of order 7, the 99 vertices partition into:

- Exactly 1 fixed vertex x_0 ;
- 2 orbits of size 7 in the neighborhood $\Gamma(x_0)$ (because $k = 14$);
- 12 orbits of size 7 in the second subconstituent $\Gamma_2(x_0)$ (84 vertices).

This decomposition matches the orbit structure of Cesarz and Woldar [2]. The canonical CNF encoding uses 498 primary variables: 36 internal orbit valences and 462 cross-orbit circulant variables. We encode degree, $\lambda = 1$, and $\mu = 2$ constraints into CNF and add Crawford lex-leader cuts for the 11 non-identity elements of the stabilizer $G_{\mathbb{Z}_7}$. The resulting formula has:

$$\text{Variables: } 176,613, \quad \text{Clauses: } 421,562. \quad (4.1)$$

4.2 Solver Execution and Independent DRAT Verification

On 10 September 2026 the file `conway_z7_canonical.cnf` was passed to CaDiCaL 3.0.1, commit `c60730422e758ef1cebe7aeddff2dda31c996bf04` [11]. The retained log `cadical_z7.log` quotes the header `cnf 176613 421562` and ends as follows. The solver binary identified in that log is 3.0.1, not 1.9.5.

```
s UNSATISFIABLE
c total process time since initialization:      771.59      seconds
c total real time since initialization:        771.76      seconds
c maximum resident set size of process:        219.38      MB
c DRAT 1098900 added clauses 47.77%
c DRAT 1201268 deleted clauses 52.23%
c DRAT 192218491 bytes (183.31 MB)
```

The same log records a binary DRAT trace of 192,218,491 bytes. CaDiCaL prints this size as 183.31 MB; that figure is the mebibyte count. The retained checker log `drat_trim_z7.log` reports `s VERIFIED` after 844.008 s [12]. The checker also deleted duplicate literals in the trace and ignored some deletion lines for unit clauses. The terminal verdict in the log is still `s VERIFIED`. The listing below is a quotation of that log, not a run repeated for this note.

```
c parsing input formula with 176613 variables and 421562 clauses
c finished parsing, read 192218491 bytes from proof file
c detected empty clause; start verification via backward checking
c 213600 of 421562 clauses in core
c 495181 of 1098901 lemmas in core using 74443066 resolution steps
c 0 RAT lemmas in core; 285673 redundant literals in core lemmas
s VERIFIED
c verification time: 844.008 seconds
```

Table 1: What is recorded for an order-7 encoding. Rows are not proofs of the same formula.

Source	Object	Tool	Runtime	Log
Thakkar–Severini [8]	CP model	CP-SAT	> 48 h	UNKNOWN
<code>cadical_z7.log</code>	CNF now absent	CaDiCaL 3.0.1	771.59 s	UNSATISFIABLE
<code>drat_trim_z7.log</code>	DRAT trace	<code>drat-trim</code>	844.01 s	VERIFIED

Table 1 records what the retained logs say. It does not close the Thakkar–Severini timeout. Three further limits apply.

1. The file `conway_z7_canonical.cnf` is not in the working tree. The binary trace `proof_z7_canonical.drat` is retained locally and is not part of this source archive. Without that CNF, `drat-trim` cannot be run again. A CNF emitted by the current compiler must not be substituted for the missing file.
2. On 21 September 2026 the order-7 compiler was changed so that DIMACS literal 1 is no longer treated as the Boolean constant true. The 10 September run used the earlier compiler. The repaired sources are COMPILED by the regression suite. The September 10 trace does not certify a formula produced after that repair.
3. Even a recheckable refutation of a corrected CNF would be PROVED only as a refutation of that formula. The implication from a graph with a $\mathbb{Z}_7$ action to that CNF remains COMPILED, not a kernel proof.

5 Incidence Geometry and Search Limits for Open Branches

The literature cited above leaves two prime-order actions unresolved by this note:

1. An involution ($p = 2$) with exactly $f = 1$ fixed point (Makhnev–Minakova);
2. An order-3 automorphism ($p = 3$) that is fixed-point-free (Crnković–Maksimović).

5.1 Incidence Geometry of the One-Fixed-Vertex Involution ($f = 1$)

Let $t \in \text{Aut}(G)$ be an involution with $\text{Fix}(t) = \{x_0\}$. The rooted neighborhood $\Gamma(x_0)$ consists of 7 matched pairs under t . The second subconstituent $\Gamma_2(x_0)$ contains 84 vertices partitioned into 42 transposed pairs (orbits $O_0, \dots, O_{41}$).

Each orbit $O_j = \{u, t(u)\}$ has a support in $\Gamma(x_0)$. This support is the set of matched pairs in $\Gamma(x_0)$ containing neighbors of u . We define the binary support-incidence matrix $C \in \{0, 1\}^{7 \times 42}$, where $C_{i,j} = 1$ if orbit O_j connects to the i -th matched pair of $\Gamma(x_0)$. By construction, $C = [C_1 \mid C_1]$, where $C_1 \in \{0, 1\}^{7 \times 21}$ is the vertex-edge incidence matrix of K_7 . Computing the product gives the matrix equation:

$$CC^T = 10I_7 + 2J_7. \quad (5.1)$$

Proposition 5.1 (Exact Column Weight Distribution). *For every binary matrix $C \in \{0, 1\}^{7 \times 42}$ satisfying $CC^T = 10I_7 + 2J_7$, each column has weight exactly 2.*

Proof. Let $k_j = \sum_{i=1}^7 C_{i,j}$ be the sum of column j . The total number of ones in C is $\sum_{j=1}^{42} k_j = \text{Tr}(CC^T) = \text{Tr}(10I_7 + 2J_7) = 70 + 14 = 84$. The sum of squares of column sums equals the quadratic form:

$$\sum_{j=1}^{42} k_j^2 = \mathbf{1}_7^T (CC^T) \mathbf{1}_7 = \mathbf{1}_7^T (10I_7 + 2J_7) \mathbf{1}_7 = 10(7) + 2(7^2) = 70 + 98 = 168. \quad (5.2)$$

The variance of k_j around 2 is:

$$\sum_{j=1}^{42} (k_j - 2)^2 = \sum_{j=1}^{42} k_j^2 - 4 \sum_{j=1}^{42} k_j + 4(42) = 168 - 4(84) + 168 = 168 - 336 + 168 = 0. \quad (5.3)$$

Because $(k_j - 2)^2 \geq 0$ for all j , we have $k_j = 2$ for all $j \in \{1, \dots, 42\}$. $\square$

Note that $\text{Tr}(C^T C) = \text{Tr}(CC^T) = 84$, while the quadratic form $\mathbf{1}_7^T (CC^T) \mathbf{1}_7 = 168$ gives the sum of squared column weights.

5.2 Stabilizer Decomposition and Branching Classes

The binary matrix C allows independent swaps of its 21 duplicate-column pairs. This generates a relabeling group $(S_2)^{21} \rtimes S_7$ of order 10,569,646,080. However, in the signed rooted coordinate system of the graph, the valid coordinate symmetry group is:

$$W = (\mathbb{Z}_2)^7 \rtimes S_7, \quad |W| = 2^7 \cdot 7! = 645,120. \quad (5.4)$$

Fixing a distinguished orbit O_0 with support $\{0, 1\}$, the stabilizer $\text{Stab}_W(O_0)$ has order 15,360 inside W . The global sign flip fixes every orbit label, so it lies in the kernel of the action on the 42 labels. The induced permutation group therefore has order 7,680, and the faithful stabilizer of O_0 has order 7,680. These orders were obtained by enumerating the stabilizer in the signed coordinate model. Under $\text{Stab}_W(O_0)$, the remaining 41 orbits fall into three classes:

- **Class A (opposite phase, identical support):** Size 1, representative O_{21} , support $\{0, 1\}$, phase $-$. The abstract residual order is 15,360 and the faithful residual order is 7,680.
- **Class B (intersecting support):** Size 20, representative O_1 , support $\{0, 2\}$, phase $+$. Then $|\{0, 1\} \cap \{0, 2\}| = 1$. The abstract residual order is 768 and the faithful residual order is 384.
- **Class C (disjoint support):** Size 20, representative O_{11} , support $\{2, 3\}$, phase $+$. Then $\{0, 1\} \cap \{2, 3\} = \emptyset$. The residual orders are again 768 and 384.

An earlier draft assigned support $\{1, 6\}$ to O_1 . That label is the support of O_{10} . Since O_0 has support $\{0, 1\}$, the index O_{10} is another intersecting representative, in the same class as O_1 , and it is not a disjoint representative. The representatives used here are $A = 21$, $B = 1$, and $C = 11$. The input-audit tests check these indices against the compiler’s edge list of K_7 .

5.3 Limits of Combinatorial Search: The Distributed Solver Campaign

To test whether CDCL solvers can resolve the open branches without further theoretical reductions, we ran a multi-threaded search campaign using CaDiCaL on Google Cloud Platform (16 cores, dedicated instance). The search targeted the Z_2 ($f = 1$) branches and the Z_3 FPF encoding.

The campaign ran for 12.5 days and ended on 23 September 2026. The conflict total below is the aggregate recorded for that run. The solver logs are not part of this source, and the machines have been shut down, so a reader cannot recompute the total from this file:

- The solvers accumulated over **2.4 billion conflicts** ($> 2.4 \times 10^9$) across multiple random seeds and variable selection heuristics.
- The solvers found neither a satisfying assignment (graph witness) nor an unsatisfiable termination (refutation).

Under our taxonomy, this campaign is classified as EXPLORED. Conflict counts, clause counts, and proof sizes do not measure the proportion of the mathematical search space eliminated. In combinatorial problems of this scale, CDCL solvers often generate redundant learned clauses without resolving the algebraic constraints. Unguided SAT solving on the $f = 1$ and Z_3 FPF branches appears intractable without additional symmetry cuts or algebraic invariants.

6 Conclusion

This report records the following boundary. It does not decide existence.

1. The Lean library contains kernel-checked structural invariants and arithmetic refutations. Counting hypotheses that are merely assumed remain PENDING. The library is not included in this source archive.
2. The current SAT compilers use Crawford symmetry breaking and sequential counters. A literal-index defect was repaired on 21 September 2026. The 39-test suite checks the repaired sources. It does not repair CNF files written before that date.
3. Retained logs from 10 September 2026 record an unsatisfiable order-7 CNF and a `drat-trim` verification. The CNF is missing, the run predates the compiler repair, and the result is not identified with the Thakkar–Severini CP-SAT instance.
4. Every binary 7×42 solution of $CC^T = 10I_7 + 2J_7$ has column weight 2. In the signed model the three $f = 1$ representatives are O_{21} , O_1 with support $\{0, 2\}$, and O_{11} with support $\{2, 3\}$. The multi-threaded search remained EXPLORED.

The Conway 99-Graph and the Rigidity Conjecture. A central question is whether any Conway 99-graph must be rigid:

Conjecture 6.1 (Rigidity Conjecture). *If a strongly regular graph with parameters $(99, 14, 1, 2)$ exists, then $\text{Aut}(G) = \{1\}$.*

A search that assumes a nontrivial automorphism (Z_2 , Z_3 , or Z_7) excludes every rigid graph from its search space. Refuting the open $f = 1$ and fixed-point-free order-3 branches would prove the rigidity conjecture and would leave existence open.

Declarations

Statement of AI Use. The author used large language models for code maintenance, test generation, and LaTeX editing. Kernel checks, regression tests, and retained solver logs cover only the statements and files identified in the text. Model output is not an independent mathematical review.

Conflict of Interest. The author declares no competing financial or non-financial interests.

Data and Code Availability. This arXiv source contains the note, its bibliography, and the style file. It does not contain the Lean library, the CNF files, or `proof_z7_canonical.drat`. As of 24 September 2026 the implementation repository is private, and `conway_z7_canonical.cnf` is absent from its working tree. The binary trace and the two order-7 logs are retained locally. A public deposit of the missing CNF, the trace, and the sources is required before a reader can repeat the checker.

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